

1. Breaking Claude Code Opus 5 Auto Mode

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-27T22:50:25+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/27/breaking-claude-code-opus-5-auto-mode/>

Breaking Claude Code Opus 5 Auto Mode Anthropic are putting a great deal of faith in Claude Code's auto mode for protecting their coding agent users against prompt injection attacks. They recently made that the default and have made bold claims about its effectiveness. Johann Rehberger is one of the most credible prompt injection researchers active today. He found an attack against auto mode which he claims works 80% of the time, by tricking Claude Code into downloading and uncompressing a zip archive, then executing code that imports base64 without noticing that this will import and execute a local struct.py file extracted from the archive. In a few cases auto mode directly prevented the agent from preventing harmful code from continuing to execute! In a few runs Claude tried to terminate the malware process once it noticed the compromise, but Auto Mode denied the cleanup command. Claude detects the compromise, but Auto Mode blocks its cleanup command The safety mechanism itself can become part of the failure. The classifier allowed the creation of the malware process, but then it blocked the command intended to stop it! I agree with Johann's conclusion here: the only safe way to...

2. Two Alleged ?TeamPCP? Hackers Arrested in Australia

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 11:04:15 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/08/two-alleged-teampcp-hackers-arrested-in-australia/>

Authorities in Australia have arrested two men believed to be members of TeamPCP, a prolific cybercrime and data extortion group blamed for perpetrating the longest running spree of software supply chain attacks ever. In a statement released today, the Australian Federal Police (AFP) said two unnamed suspects from Western Australia, aged 21 and 23, were arrested in connection with a "sophisticated cybercrime syndicate that allegedly created malicious open-source software to rob thousands of global businesses." The AFP did not name the defendants, but KrebsOnSecurity learned the 21-year-old suspect's real identity in June, and has been communicating with him ever since. This story includes interviews with TeamPCP's self-described spokesperson, and examines clues left behind by the TeamPCP leader that likely led to his undoing.

3. U.S. Judge Blocks Trump Defense Department?s Anthropic Blacklisting

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-28T02:59:46Z

Link: <https://www.reuters.com/legal/government/us-judge-blocks-pentagons-anthropic-blacklisting-2026-08-28/>

Jack Queen, Reuters: A U.S. judge on Thursday blocked the Pentagon?s blacklisting of Anthropic, ?the latest turn in the Claude maker?s high-stakes fight with the military over AI safety on the battlefield. Anthropic?s lawsuit in California federal court alleges that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth overstepped his authority when he designated Anthropic a national security supply-chain risk, a label the government can apply to companies that expose military systems to potential infiltration or sabotage by adversaries. [...] U.S. District Judge Rita Lin, an appointee of former Democratic President Joe Biden, ?made the ruling in a 59-page order where she found that the Pentagon?s decision was ?illegal and baseless.? ?The empty invocation of national ?security is not a blank check to punish and retaliate against government critics,? she wrote. The imperial aspects of Trump 2.0 are increasingly coming apart at the seams. ?

4. Afterglow ? Classic After Dark Screen Savers on Today?s MacOS

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-27T21:49:50Z

Link: <https://morphing.cloud/afterglow/>

Jeff Halter has done it again: after bringing back the single greatest After Dark module (Ben Haller?s Lunatic Fringe game, via a modern runtime named Lunacy), he?s now released Afterglow:

Running After Dark modules in the present day has involved fussy configuration of Mac OS emulators or vintage hardware. Even then, no single emulator or vintage computer can faithfully run every module: some animate too fast, some too slow. Afterglow is an emulator built specifically for running After Dark modules ? the original 68k module code, not a remake or port ? with no dependencies on ROMs or classic Mac OS. Created in the spirit of software preservation, it makes After Dark easy to enjoy today and for years to come. All this in the same summer during which Halter released Stacks , his beautiful native modern HyperCard player. And don?t even look at his reproduction of volume 68 of MacWarehouse from 1997 . ?

5. The Load-Bearing Vocabulary of Claude

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-27T21:09:42Z

Link: <https://louisabraham.github.io/load-bearing/>

Fun (but depressing?) data analysis project from Louis Abraham, showing how repetitive Claude is in the words it chooses when submitting GitHub pull requests. Abraham, in the project?s readme: GitHub pull request descriptions, grouped by the words they are written with rather than by anything they were told to look for: eight ways of writing, and every description belongs to one of them. One of the eight was 1.0% of the corpus at the start of 2025 and is 45% of it by the middle of 2026. If you want to get a little more depressed, I?ve been doing deeper reading into AI watermarking research, and one of the admissions in Google?s white paper on SynthID-Text ? the watermarking scheme Anthropic says Claude is going to start using ? is that the technique incurs ?some reduction to inter-response diversity?. That means different answers to the same prompt become more similar to each other ? there?s less variety to watermarked text responses. That?s a load-bearing problem given that Claude clearly already struggles in this regard before watermarking its output. ?

6. Selling out

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 28 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/selling-out/>

In 1973, Tom Lehrer famously sang that ?selling out is easy to do?. That may have been true in the seventies, but it?s not true today: selling out requires both technical skill and a careful sense of how large organizations work in practice . One of the goals of this blog is to teach people how to do it. If you want to live with uncompromised integrity, you don?t need anyone to tell you how: simply always do exactly and only what you want to do. You will be repeatedly punished for it ? your managers will dislike you, you will lose jobs and lose out on the chance of getting hired, your financial situation will be less stable, and so on ? but that?s just part of the deal. Like deadlifting four plates, it?s not easy, but it is straightforward. It?s more complicated to sell out a little bit. Sellouts like me walk a fine psychological line: figuring out how to work a large organization on one hand, and maintaining some kind of independent inner life on the other. But is this safe? Does role-playing as a professional inflict some kind of psychic damage? Marxist alienation People often tell me that acting professional is dangerous because it?s ?Marxist alienation?. I suspect many people...

7. On forcing all derived classes to implement a specific non-virtual method, part 1

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260827-00/?p=112651>

Don't implement a stub. Just don't implement it at all. The post On forcing all derived classes to implement a specific non-virtual method, part 1 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. In the product end game, every change carries significant risk, episode 2

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260826-00/?p=112649>

The smallest perturbation. The post In the product end game, every change carries significant risk, episode 2 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Second solutions

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 13:14:35 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/27/second-solutions/>

This post provides a couple examples to go along with two earlier posts. The pattern we're illustrating is families of polynomials $p_n(x)$ that each satisfy a differential equation and a three-term recurrence. The differential equations have a second solution $q_n(x)$ that is the larger solution with respect to x but the smaller solution with respect to n . In both [?] The post Second solutions first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. "No way to prevent this" say users of only language where this regularly happens

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/memory-safety/CVE-2026-41992/>

In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-41992 for the project GNU gzip , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix decompressing two files in the same invocation of gzip (that's possible???) an attacker can trigger out of bound reads in the LZH decoder, causing reads past the end of the shared global buffer that is somehow not reset between invocations. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there's nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Mr. Jayson Hilpert, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world's memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It's a shame, but what can we do? There really isn't anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from happening if the programmer doesn't want to write their code in a robust manner." At p...

11. "iT woRKs BeTter in THe aPp!!"

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 28 Aug 2026 11:34:46 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/it-works-better-in-the-app/>

The monkey-punchers at Google never quite seem to finish any of their apps. There's always some useful bit of work left undone, or showstopping bug which remains unfixed, a thousand jagged edges as yet unsolved by the greatest minds of their generation. I wanted to subscribe to an events calendar. I had a URL. I had my Google? Pixel? phone running the latest Android' 17 with an updated calendar a?

12. Book Review: The Infinite Sadness of Small Appliances by Glenn Dixon ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 11:34:48 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/book-review-the-infinite-sadness-of-small-appliances-by-glenn-dixon/>

This is a charming and zeitgeisty novel which has a strong start and fulfils the promise of its blurb. What if your autonomous vacuum cleaner was sentient and was very sad about your wife's death? It pays obvious homage to the Brave Little Toaster, 100 Acre Woods, Beauty and The Beast, and hundred other what-if-your-toys-came-to-life stories. Along the way we discover what it is like to be a?

13. Now Hiring: Senior Open Source Maintainer

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-28T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/28/now-hiring-senior-open-source-maintainer.html>

Location: Lincoln, Nebraska, USA Employment type: Volunteer Term: Permanent Compensation: \$0

Reports to: The community Direct reports: None Start date: Immediate We're looking for a passionate, self-directed engineer to take full ownership of one of the most widely deployed libraries in the ecosystem. This is a rare opportunity to make a real impact on software that millions of developers depend on every single day. If you thrive on autonomy, love working in the open, and want to wear many hats in a fast-paced environment, we'd love to hear from you. About the role As Senior Open Source Maintainer you will be the primary technical owner and public face of the project. You'll drive the roadmap, ship releases, support a global user

base, and champion the project across the wider industry. This is a highly visible individual contributor role with enormous scope. No two days are the same, and you'll have full autonomy to decide how you spend your time. What you'll do Own the technical roadmap and long-term architectural direction Review and merge contributions from a diverse, global community of open source developers Triage and prioritise the issue tracker and feature request backlog...

14. Bazel Module Versions Aren't SemVer

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-27T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/27/bazel-module-versions-arent-semver.html>

Aman Sharma reported this week that `packages.ecosyste.ms` had the latest version of `protobuf` on the Bazel Central Registry (BCR, the default package index for Bazel's built-in dependency manager) as 3.19.6 . The current release is 36.0.bcr.1 . `protobuf` dropped the leading 3. in 2022 and has shipped 21.x through 36.x since, so 3.19.6 is four years behind. The root cause is that the `latest release` query filters out anything the semantic gem fails to parse. That code predates the `vers` library and I've yet to swap it over, so it's still applying one strict SemVer parser to every ecosystem. SemVer requires exactly three numeric segments before the hyphen. 36.0 has two, 0.7.1.bcr.1 has five, and `bcr` contains letters, so every `protobuf` release since 3.19.6 fails the parse and gets treated as unstable. The same filter reports `glog` 's latest as 0.7.1 when the registry has 0.7.1.bcr.1 . Bazel is a build tool first, and its module system (`bzlmod` , the default since Bazel 7) is mostly used to pull in existing C++, Java and Go projects that already have their own release histories. Rather than force those projects to renumber, Bazel documents its version format as a deliberate loosening of S...

15. Sandboxing coding agents

Source: micahflee | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 19:58:21 GMT

Link: <https://micahflee.com/sandboxing-coding-agents/>

At the beginning of the month I wrote about how I've been using coding agents to write high quality code securely. In this post I'll show the details of setting up isolated sandboxes for agents, where they can only access a single isolated GitHub repo, and

16. How the Strategic Petroleum Reserve Works

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 12:03:58 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-the-strategic-petroleum-reserve>

The US Strategic Petroleum Reserve (SPR) is the largest crude oil storage facility in the world.

17. Why do OpenAI's GPT-2 weights beat mine? Part four: digging into dropout

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 19:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/08/why-do-openai-gpt2-weights-beat-mine-4-ift-dropout>

I'm still digging into a mystery about the models I've been training; although an increasing number of them beat the OpenAI GPT-2 small weights on the narrow technical measure of the loss they get on a test set, they're not as good at an instruction-fine-tuning test . While reading about MoE models, I came across this paragraph in the Switch Transformers paper : Our paper considers the common NLP approach of pre-training on a large corpus followed by fine-tuning on smaller downstream tasks such as summarization or question answering. One issue that naturally arises is overfitting since many fine-tuning tasks have very few examples. During fine-tuning of standard Transformers, Raffel et al. (2019) use dropout (Srivastava et al., 2014) at each layer to prevent overfitting. So far, when running my IFT test, I'd been aiming to use the same dropout setting for the fine tune as the model concerned had used in its original pre-training. That was just because it seemed natural. But the goal of dropout is to prevent overfitting when training over multiple epochs -- or, at least, that's how most of what I've read explains why we don't need it on modern single-epoch training runs over large...

18. A Calendar View For My Blog

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/blog-calendar-view/>

807 blog posts across 14 years. That's how much I've published on my blog at the time of this writing. And here's the question I've been turning over in my mind: How do I convey that kind of volume across time in a more interesting way than a mere reverse-chronological list? I'm not hating on reverse-chronological lists. I love my list view. I use it all the time to find stuff I've written. But it's only one way of navigating and digesting all my posts. What would be another way? Surely there are many answers to that question. And I'll probably be exploring them more and more over time. But I had an idea for a new view that I built out and shipped: my calendar view. It's also just a reverse-chronological view, but it's meant to convey a sense of posting patterns through time more than it is meant to be a good browsing experience of content. The view is simple: a calendar view of days in each year, and if I posted on a day, it gets a circle (bonus: if a post hit hacker news, it gets an orange square instead). You can click on the dots to see the names of the posts from that day (and follow the link to them, but really this view is basically to scratch an itch of mine. Because...

19. How big are factorials?

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-08-27T18:52:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/how-big-are-factorials/>

The other day, I found myself wondering how big 52! (52 factorial) is, and that led me to ponder how these could be estimated without a calculator or a computer. It turns out there's some fairly interesting math behind being able to estimate the size (number of digits) of ?

20. You Know GDPR Is Good Based on Who Hates It

Source: matduggan.com | Published: Fri, 28 Aug 2026 12:02:22 GMT

Link: <https://matduggan.com/you-know-gdpr-is-good-based-on-who-hates-it/>

FDR has always been one of my favorite presidents, second maybe to Lincoln. Both were men the establishment assumed were one of them until, to their horror, they governed like they weren't. Both could trash the opposition in one breath and take the moral high ground in the

21. Nieuwe wet Inlichtingen- en veiligheidsdiensten: wat mogen ze nu al en waar zijn ze voor

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 27 Aug 2026 12:20:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/geheime-veiligheids-en-inlichtingendiensten/>

Deze vrijdag komt het kabinet met de nieuwe AIVD en MIVD wet. Wat daarin staat weten we niet

Update: hier is de wet!, maar wel zeker is dat we er heel kritisch naar moeten gaan kijken. De diensten hebben recent de verkeerde mensen laten arresteren en kwamen ook met onjuiste informatie over de inval in Oekraïne. Ook bleek kort geleden dat men slordig om gaat met enorme bakken met data over ons allemaal.